



Reflex mastery: “Pant’s keeping relies heavily on reflexes and hand-eye coordination, which is why he remains highly effective.” — Saba Karim. PTI

he could hold his place on batting merit alone. His versatility only enhances his value as a wicketkeeper with modern glovework and the ability to contribute as a sharp outfielder.

“It’s refreshing to see how far wicketkeepers have evolved. Earlier, few of us worked on outfielding. Today’s keepers train to be assets anywhere on the field, which is why they add value even when they’re not behind the stumps,” said Karim.

With the management keen on playing at least five bowlers at home, including two all-rounders in Ravindra Jadeja and Washington Sundar, Jurel’s inclusion in place of Reddy should provide greater

batting assurance without compromising wicket-taking ability. If India ever plays both Pant and Jurel together, the next question is obvious: who keeps wickets?

Pant’s batting is rooted in the unorthodox. Jurel, by contrast, is textbook in his approach. Yet behind the stumps, the contrast flips. As Karim observed, Pant and Jurel represent two distinct eras of wicketkeeping.

“Jurel can be classified as a modern-day wicketkeeper, his setup, stances, movements, and footwork reflect today’s approach. Pant, meanwhile, follows the older style, his stance and glovework are more in line with what we’ve seen from traditional keepers.

Karim notes that Jurel’s technique minimises strain while keeping his body aligned with the line of the ball. “His footwork stays in sync with the pitch’s variations, which allows him

to react better to whatever comes behind the stumps. Pant’s keeping relies heavily on reflexes and hand-eye coordination, which is why he remains highly effective.”

According to Karim, two aspects stand out in Jurel’s keeping: his upright stance and his collection technique.

“Jurel’s stance and collection are his biggest strengths. He stays slightly more upright, even to spinners, keeping his head and alignment towards the ball. That helps him rise with the delivery, the most basic but crucial aspect of wicketkeeping.”

Another subtle difference lies in their arm positioning while standing up to the stumps.

“When standing up to the stumps, Jurel keeps his arms slightly away from his knees, allowing free hand movement. Pant, however, positions his arms between his legs, which can